

GOLD



» PRAVEEN KUMAR

Category: Athletics (Men's High Jump T64)

Praveen Kumar dominated the Paris Paralympics, capturing gold in the men's high jump T64 class with a stunning performance. The final included athletes from both the T44 and T64 classes, reserved for those with limb deficiencies, such as amputations or shortened limbs.

Born with a short leg, Praveen never let his condition hold him back. In Paris, he cleared every height — from 1.89m to 2.08m — on his first attempt, securing the title with a new Asian record and personal best.

Setting new records has become a habit for the young athlete from Noida. His gold-medal jump surpassed the Asian record he set three years earlier at the Tokyo Paralympics, where, at just 18 years old, he won a silver medal with a 2.07m clearance. That performance also made him the youngest Indian para-athlete to win a medal at the 2021 Games.

Before his Tokyo success, Praveen had already broken the previous 2.05m record at the World Para Athletics Fazza Grand Prix. A year later, he set a new Asian Games record with a 2.02m jump to claim gold.

Praveen's athletic journey began with a passion for volleyball, but he soon shifted his focus to high jump, where he competed fiercely against able-bodied athletes. This pivot to para-athletics proved to be the right choice, as Praveen quickly rose to prominence, breaking records and making history.